

Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—
“They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin”*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

EBENEZER 87.87.87.87

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,

This musical system features a treble and bass staff in G major (one sharp) and 12/8 time. The treble staff contains a vocal melody with eighth and sixteenth notes, while the bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment with chords and moving lines. The lyrics are written below the treble staff.

in the strife of truth with false-hood, for the good or e - vil side;

This musical system continues the hymn on the same treble and bass staves. The melody and accompaniment follow the same pattern as the first system, with the lyrics continuing below the treble staff.

Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch-ed crust,

This musical system consists of a treble and bass staff in G major (one sharp). The treble staff features a melody with eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together, and rests. The bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment with chords and moving lines. The lyrics are written below the treble staff, aligned with the notes.

ere her cause bring fame and prof-it, and 'tis prosp-'rous to be just;

This musical system continues the piece. The treble staff melody concludes with a final note and a double bar line. The bass staff continues with a similar rhythmic pattern. The lyrics are aligned with the treble staff.



2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth;

This block contains the first line of a musical score. It features a treble and bass staff in G major (one sharp) and 12/8 time. The melody is written in the treble staff, and the bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment. The lyrics are written below the treble staff. The first line of lyrics is "2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth;".



they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.

This block contains the second line of a musical score. It continues the melody and accompaniment from the first line. The lyrics are written below the treble staff. The second line of lyrics is "they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.".

Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp-fires! We our-selves must pil - grims be,

nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por-tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key.

3 Though the cause of e - vil pros-per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;

This block contains the first line of a musical score. It features a treble and bass staff in G major (one sharp) and 12/8 time. The treble staff has a melody with eighth and sixteenth notes, while the bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment with chords and moving lines. The lyrics are printed below the staves.

though her por - tion be the scaf-fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.

This block contains the second line of the musical score, continuing the melody and accompaniment from the first line. The lyrics are printed below the staves.

Then it is the brave one choos-es, while the cow-ard stands a - side

This musical system consists of a treble and a bass staff, both in the key of D major (indicated by two sharps). The treble staff contains the melody, which begins with a half note chord (D4, F#4), followed by a quarter note (G4), and then a series of eighth and sixteenth notes. The bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment, starting with a half note chord (D3, F#3) and continuing with various chords and moving lines. The lyrics are written below the treble staff, aligned with the notes.

till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de - nied.

This musical system continues the piece, ending with a double bar line. It maintains the same key signature and structure as the first system. The melody in the treble staff concludes with a half note chord (D4, F#4). The bass staff also concludes with a half note chord (D3, F#3). The lyrics are aligned with the notes, ending with a period.